

TOBIAS WEKHOF

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📍 Zürichbergstrasse 18, CH-8092 Zurich

Research Topics: Environmental Economics, Sustainable Finance, Applied Microeconomics

Methods: Econometrics, Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning

EDUCATION

ETH Zurich Ph.D. in Economics	<i>Zurich, Switzerland</i> 2017 – 2022
University of Zurich M.A. in Economics	<i>Zurich, Switzerland</i> 2014 – 2016
Université de Lorraine B.A. in Economics, <i>dual degree with Sciences Po</i>	<i>Nancy, France</i> 2011 – 2014
Higher School of Economics <i>Visiting Student, Economics and Russian language</i>	<i>Moscow, Russia</i> 2012 – 2013
Sciences Po Paris B.A. in Economics and Politics	<i>Paris, France</i> 2010 – 2013

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Senior Researcher (Oberassistent), ETH Zurich <i>Chair of Energy and Public Economics</i>	<i>Zurich, Switzerland</i> 2025 – Present
Postdoctoral Researcher, ETH Zurich <i>Chair of Energy and Public Economics</i>	<i>Zurich, Switzerland</i> 2023 – 2024
Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Zurich <i>Department of Banking and Finance</i>	<i>Zurich, Switzerland</i> 2023 – 2024
Visiting Scholar, Stanford University <i>Program on Energy and Sustainable Development</i>	<i>Stanford, USA</i> March-May, 2024
Graduate Research and Teaching Assistant, ETH Zurich <i>Chair of Energy and Public Economics</i>	<i>Zurich, Switzerland</i> 2017 – 2022

PUBLICATIONS

- ”Sustainable Finance Literacy and the Determinants of Sustainable Investing,” Massimo Filippini, Markus Leipold, and Tobias Wekhof, *Journal of Banking and Finance* (2024) [[link](#)]
Money Inclusion and Awareness Award 2023 for “Best Academic Project or Paper.”
- ”Using narratives to infer preferences in understanding the energy efficiency gap,” Tobias Wekhof and Sébastien Houde, *Nature Energy* (2023) [[link](#)]
- ”The effect of culture on energy efficient vehicle ownership,” Massimo Filippini and Tobias Wekhof, *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management* (2021) [[link](#)]

WORKING PAPERS

"Bank-Advisor Certification and Willingness to Pay for Sustainable Finance Products," Katharina Holzheu and Tobias Wekhof, CER-ETHZ WP 25/396 (2025) [[link](#)]

"The Impact of Sustainable Finance Literacy on Investment Decisions," Massimo Filippini, Markus Leippold, and Tobias Wekhof, Swiss Finance Institute Research Paper No. 24-57 (2024) [[link](#)]

"Explaining the Attitude-Behavior Gap for Sustainable Investors: Open vs. Closed-Ended Questions," Tobias Wekhof (2024) [[link](#)]

"Conditional Topic Allocations for Open-Ended Survey Responses," *Reject & Resubmit at Political Analysis* Tobias Wekhof (2024) [[link](#)] [*Python package: CTApY*]

WORK IN PROGRESS

"The Hidden Cost of Minimum Quality Standards: Evidence from an Ex Post Welfare Analysis of the U.S. Clothes Washers Market," Sébastien Houde and Tobias Wekhof

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

"Additional Value From Free-Text Diagnoses in Electronic Health Records: Hybrid Dictionary and Machine Learning Classification Study," Tarun Mehra, Tobias Wekhof, and Dagmar Keller *JMIR Medical Informatics* (2024) [[link](#)]

"Integrating artificial intelligence with expert knowledge in global environmental assessments: opportunities, challenges and the way ahead," Veruska Muccione et al. (including Tobias Wekhof), *Regional Environmental Change* 24, 121 (2024) [[link](#)]

"ChatClimate: Grounding Conversational AI in Climate Science," Saeid Vaghefi et al. (including Tobias Wekhof), *Communications Earth & Environment* (2023) [[link](#)]

"Chatreport: Democratizing Sustainability Disclosure Analysis through LLM-based Tools," Jingwei Ni et al. (including Tobias Wekhof) *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing: System Demonstrations* (2023) [[link](#)]

ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

2025: Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (scheduled; Bergen, NO); 7th Annual Conference Global Research Alliance for Sustainable Finance and Investment (GRASFI) (scheduled, Paris, FR); 18th International Behavioural Finance Conference (scheduled, London, UK)

2024: 9th Cherry Blossom Financial Education Institute (Stanford, USA), ETHZ Seminar in Economics and Data Science (online), 2024 European Meeting of the Economic Science Association (Helsinki, FI), G53 Network Brown Bag Lunch seminar (online).

2023: Workshop for Environmental Policy Evaluation (St. Gallen, CH), 2023 Annual Congress of the Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics (Neuchâtel, CH), ZEW internal seminar (Mannheim, DE)

2022: 3rd Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop (virtual); University of Cologne, C-SEB Seminar (virtual); Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Rimini, IT); 9th Atlantic Workshop on Energy and Environmental Economics (A Toxa, ES), 4th Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop (virtual); 5th Annual Conference Global Research Alliance for Sustainable Finance and Investment (GRASFI), (Zurich, CH); 4th WESFi Kassel (virtual); Asia Pacific Financial Education Institute (APFEI) 2022 (virtual).

2021: Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (virtual), 1st Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop (virtual)

2020: Empirical Methods in Energy Economics (Zurich, CH).

2018: World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economics (Gothenburg, SE); 8th Atlantic Workshop on Energy and Environmental Economics (A Toxa, ES).
2017: Empirical Methods in Energy Economics (Los Angeles, USA).

GRANTS AND APPROVED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Swiss Federal Office of Energy, (with Massimo Filippini and Markus Leippold) "Sustainable investment preferences and the green transition in Switzerland"	12.2022 CHF 240.000
Global Excellence in Modeling Climate and Energy Policies (GEOCEP) Travel Grant from the European Union's Horizon 2020 program	03.2024-05.2024 CHF 6.000

HONORS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

G53 Financial Literacy and Personal Finance Research Network Research fellow	2024 – present
German National Academic Foundation Merit based scholarship, top 0.5% of German students (Studienstiftung des deutschen Volkes)	2012 – 2017

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ad-hoc Referee Journal of Environmental Economics and Management, Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance, SN Business & Economics, Journal of Economics and Business	
Swiss Association for Energy Economics Student chapter president	2017 – 2019
Workshop organization Annual PhD workshop, Swiss Association for Energy Economics	2017 – 2019

PERSONAL SKILLS

Programming:	R, Python, Stata, Matlab, Latex, SQL
Languages:	German (native), English (fluent, academic level), French (fluent, academic level) Russian (advanced), Italian (advanced)
Certifications:	Project Management Professional (PMP, 2024)

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES / OTHER

- Yoga, Meditation, Rowing
- Co-President ETH Alumni Wine-club (2018 – present)

Citizenship: Germany, USA, Swiss Permanent Resident (C-Permit)